MIL-H-13102D
4 May 1983
SUPERSEDING
MIL-H-13102C
28 January 1969

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

HOLDER, CARTRIDGE, BELT, CAL. .38,

LEATHER, BLACK, 6-ROUND

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This document covers the requirements for a 6-round, leather, cartridge holder of one type and size (see 6.1).

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents. Unless otherwise specified, the following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this document to the extent specified herein.

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

A-A-1249	-	Paper, Wrapping, Tissue.
V-T-285	-	Thread, Polyester.
KK-L-271	-	Leather, Cattlehide, Strap, Vegetable Tanned.
PPP-B-566	-	Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-636	-	Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-676	-	Boxes, Setup.
PPP-T-45	-	Tape, Gummed, Paper, Reinforced and Plain, for Sealing and Securing.

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: U.S. Army Natick Research and Development Laboratories, Natick, MA 01760 by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

FSC 8465

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-18T00:03Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

STANDARDS

FEDERAL

FED-STD-751 - Stitches, Seams, and Stitchings.

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.
MIL-STD-130 - Identification Marking of U.S. Military Property.
MIL-STD-147 - Palletized Unit Loads.
MIL-STD-1188 - Commercial Packaging of Supplies and Equipment.

DRAWING

U.S. ARMY NATICK RESEARCH AND DEVELOPMENT LABORATORIES

2-4-41 - Holder, Cartridge, Belt, Cal. .38, Leather, Black, 6-Round.

(Copies of documents required by manufacturers in connection with specific acquisition functions should be obtained from the contracting activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein, the text of this document shall take precedence.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 First article. When specified, a sample shall be subjected to first article inspection (see 4.3, 6.2 and 6.4).

3.2 Materials. Materials specified shall conform to the applicable documents and requirements specified herein.

3.2.1 Leather. The leather shall be 4/64 and 8/64 inch thick conforming to types I, II, III or IV, class 1 of KK-L-271 except that the thickness tolerances shall be plus 1/64 minus 1/128 inch. The grain side of the leather shall be dyed black and smooth finished, insuring a long-lasting lustrous finish. The color of the flesh side shall be natural.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-18T00:03Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.2.2 Thread, polyester. The polyester thread for all stitching shall conform t type I, class 1, subclass A, size 3 of V-T-285.

3.2.2.1 Color. The thread shall be dyed black and shall show fastness to perspiration equal to or better than the standard sample. When no standard sample is available, the thread shall show good fastness to perspiration.

3.2.3 Sealer. The edges and the laps of the leather shall be finished with a colorless aqueous solution of a sealer. Gum tragacanth has been found to be suitable.

3.3 Construction. The construction shall conform in all respects to the Drawing 2-4-41 and as specified herein.

3.3.1 Stitches and stitchings. All stitches and stitchings, shall conform to FED-STD-751: type 301 with 6 to 8 stitches per inch.

3.3.1.1 Type 301 stitching. Ends of stitching shall be backstitched or overstitched not less than 1 inch except where ends are turned under or caught in other seams and stitching. Thread tension shall be maintained so that there will b no loose stitching resulting in loose bobbin or top thread or excessively tight stitching resulting in puckering of the materials sewn. The lock shall be imbedded in the materials sewed.

3.3.1.1.1 Repairs of type 301 stitching. Repairs of type 301 stitching shall be as follows:

When thread breaks, bobbin runouts, two or more consecutive skipped stitches, loose or excessively tight stitching occur during stitching. The stitching shall b repaired by removing the defective stitching, without damaging the materials, and restitching as specified in 3.3.1.1.

3.4 Marking. The marking "US" shall be indented in the grain side of the cartridge holder back and shall be located in the middle approximately 1/8 inch below the top. The contract number shall be indented in the flesh side of the cartridge holder back and shall be located in the middle approximately 1/8 inch below the top. Figures shall be Arabic and letters Gothic. Figures and letters shall be 3/8 inch in height. Marking shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-130.

3.5 Replacement of defective components. During the cutting and manufacturing process, components having material defects or damages that are classified as defects in 4.4.2 shall be removed from production and replaced with non-defective and properly matched components.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-18T00:03Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.6 Workmanship. The cartridge holder shall conform to the quality of product established by this document. Occurrence of defects shall not exceed the applicable acceptable quality levels.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspection set forth in the document where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Certificate of compliance. Where certificates of compliance are submitted, the Government reserves the right to check test such items to determine the validity of the certification.

4.2 Classification of inspection. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

(a) First article inspection (see 4.3).
(b) Quality conformance inspection (see 4.4).

4.3 First article inspection. When a first article is required (see 6.2), it shall be examined for the defects specified in 4.4.2 and 4.4.3. The presence of any defect shall be cause for rejection of the first article.

4.4 Quality conformance inspection. Unless otherwise specified, sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

4.4.1 Components and materials inspection. In accordance with 4.1, components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with all the requirements of referenced documents unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this document or applicable purchase document.

4.4.1.1 Certification. The contractor shall furnish a certificate of compliance certifying that the sealer conforms to the requirements specified in 3.2.3.

4.4.2 End item visual examination. The end item shall be examined for the defects listed below. The lot size shall be expressed in units of holders. The sample unit shall be one holder. The inspection level shall be II and the acceptable quality level (AQL), expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 2.5 for major defects and 6.5 for total (major and minor combined) defects.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-18T00:03Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Minor
Leather components	Not specified color.	X	
	Color not uniform.		X
	Finish not smooth.	X	
	Any leather part refinished after assembly:		
	-seriously affecting serviceability or appearance	X	
	-affecting serviceability or appearance but not seriously		X
Quality of leather	Not full grain, or not full grain lightly snuffed.	X	
	Any open hole, cut, or rupture.	X	
	Brand mark, healed grub damage, scar tissue, hip mark; thin, brittle or boney area:		
	-seriously affecting serviceability or appearance	X	
	-affecting serviceability or appearance but not seriously		X
	Abraided, scratched, or other grain damage:		
	-seriously affecting serviceability or appearance	X	
	-affecting serviceability or appearance but not seriously		X
	Flanky, spongy, pipey, or stretchy leather:		
	-seriously affecting serviceability or appearance	X	
	-affecting serviceability or appearance but not seriously		X
	Any wrinkle:		
	-seriously affecting serviceability or appearance	X	
	-affecting serviceability or appearance but not seriously.		X
	Slaughter cut:		
	-seriously affecting serviceability	X	
	-affecting serviceability but not seriously		X
	Flesh side not smooth, or contains areas of loose flesh.	X	

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-18T00:03Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Minor
Thread	Not specified color.	X	
Open seams	Open seam not repaired.	X	
	Repair of open seam not as specified.		X
	NOTE: A seam shall be classified as open when one or more stitches joining a seam are broken or when two or more consecutive skipped stitches or runoffs occur.		
Runoffs (see open seams)			
Stitching type	Wrong stitch type.	X	
Stitch tension	Loose, resulting in a loosely exposed top or bobbin thread; tight, resulting in tightness of seams.	X	
Stitches per inch	One stitch less than minimum specified.		X
	Two or more stitches less than minimum specified.	X	
	One or more stitches in excess of maximum specified.		X
Stitching margin	Not as specified, affecting serviceability		X
Thread ends	Thread ends not tied and not fused.		X
Marking	Missing, incomplete, incorrect, not applied in specified manner, misplaced, or illegible.		X

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-18T00:03Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Minor
Construction and workmanship (general)	Any component or assembly misplaced, operation omitted or not properly performed:		
	-seriously affecting serviceability or appearance.	X	
	-affecting serviceability or appearance but not seriously.		X

4.4.3 End item dimensional examination. The end item shall be examined for conformance to the specified dimensions. Any dimension not within the specified tolerance shall be classified as a defect. The lot size shall be expressed in units of holders. The sample unit shall be one holder. The inspection level shall be S-3 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 4.0.

4.4.4 Packaging inspection. An examination shall be made to determine that preservation, packing, and marking comply with the section 5 requirements. Defects shall be scored in accordance with the list below. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully packaged with the exception that it need not be closed. Examination of closure defects listed below shall be made on shipping containers fully packaged. The lot size shall be the number of containers in the inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 2.5.

Examine	Defect
Marking (exterior and interior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; of improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Materials	Any component missing, damaged or not as specified.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components, such as incomplete closure of container flap, loose strapping, improper taping, or inadequate stapling. Bulged or distorted container.
Content	Number of intermediate packs per container is more or less than specified. Number of cartridge holders per intermediate pack is more or less than specified. 1/

1/ For this defect, six intermediate packs shall be examined from each shipping container in the sample.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-18T00:03Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.4.5 Palletization examination. An examination shall be made to determine that the palletization complies with the section 5 requirements. Defects shall be scored in accordance with the list below. The sample unit shall be one palletized unit load fully packaged. The lot size shall be the number of palletized unit loads in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-1 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 6.5.

Examine	Defect
Finished dimensions	Length, width, or height exceeds specified maximum requirement.
Palletization	Pallet pattern not as specified. Interlocking of loads not as specified. Load not bonded with required straps as specified.
Weight	Exceeds maximum load limits.
Marking	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; of improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Preservation. Preservation shall be level A or Commercial as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A. Each holder shall be completely wrapped in tissue paper conforming to type I, of A-A-1249. Ten unit wrapped holders shall then be intermediately packed in a folding paperboard box conforming to variety 1, style III, type G, class 1 of PPP-B-566; or set-up paperboard box conforming to type I, variety 1, class A, style 4 of PPP-B-676. Inside dimensions of the paperboard box shall be 6-3/4 inches in length, 6-3/8 inches in width, and 2-1/8 inches in depth. Box closure shall be secured with 2-inch minimum width gummed paper tape conforming to type III, grade B of PPP-T-45 applied girthwise around the center of the box.

5.1.2 Commercial. The holders shall be preserved in accordance with MIL-STD-1188.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or Commercial as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A packing. Six hundred holders, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a fiberboard shipping container conforming to style RSC, grade V2s of PPP-B-636. Level A intermediate packs shall be packed on end ten in length, three in width, and two in depth. Inside dimensions of each shipping container shall

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-18T00:03Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

approximate 22-3/4 inches in length, 20-1/4 inches in width and 14 inches in depth. Approximate dimensions are furnished as a guide only. Each shipping container shall be closed in accordance with method III, waterproofed in accordance with method V, and reinforced as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636, except that inspection shall be in accordance with 4.4.4.

5.2.2 Level B packing. Six hundred holders, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a fiberboard shipping container conforming to style RSC, type CF (variety SW) or SF, class domestic, grade 275 of PPP-B-636. Level A intermediate packs shall be packed on end ten in length, three in width and two in depth. Inside dimensions of each shipping container shall approximate 22-3/4 inches in length, 20-1/4 inches in width and 14 inches in depth. Approximate dimensions are furnished as a guide only. Each shipping container shall be closed in accordance with method II as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636, except that inspection shall be in accordance with 4.4.4.

5.2.2.1 Weather-resistant fiberboard containers. When specified (see 6.2), the shipping container shall be a grade V3c, V3s, or V4s fiberboard box fabricated in accordance with PPP-B-636 and closed in accordance with method III as specified in the appendix of PPP-P-636, except that the inspection shall be in accordance with 4.4.4.

5.2.3 Commercial packing. Holders, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in accordance with MIL-STD-1188.

5.3 Palletization. When specified (see 6.2), holders packed as specified in 5.2 shall be palletized in accordance with load type I of MIL-STD-147. Each prepared load shall be bonded with primary and secondary straps in accordance with bonding means K and L. Pallet patterns shall be in accordance with the appendix of MIL-STD-147. Interlocking of loads shall be effected by reversing the pattern of each course. If the container is of a size which does not conform to any of the pallet patterns specified in MIL-STD-147, the pallet pattern used shall first be approved by the contracting officer.

5.4 Marking. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or purchase order, intermediate packs, shipping containers, and palletized unit loads shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129, or MIL-STD-1188 as applicable.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The cartridge holder is intended for wear on a leather cartridge belt to hold six rounds of 38-caliber ammunition.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-18T00:03Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

6.2 Ordering data. Acquisition documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number, and date of this document.
(b) When a first article sample is required (see 3.1, 4.3 and 6.4).
(c) Selection of applicable levels of preservation and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(d) When weather-resistant grade fiberboard shipping containers are required for level B packing (see 5.2.2.1).
(e) When palletization is required (see 5.3).

6.3 Samples. For access to standard shade samples, address the procuring agency issuing the invitation for bids.

6.4 First article. When a first article is required, it shall be inspected and approved under the appropriate provisions of DAR 7-104.55. The first article should be a preproduction sample. The quantity of items required should be as specified in the contract. The contracting officer should include specific instructions in all acquisition documents regarding arrangements for inspection and approval of the first article.

6.5 Changes from previous issue. Asterisks are not used in this revision to identify changes with respect to the previous issue due to the extensiveness of the changes.

Custodians:

Army - GL
Air Force - 99

Review activities:

Army - MD
Air Force - 11
DLA - CT

User activities:

Air Force - 45, 82

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

Project No. 8465-0863

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-18T00:03Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

INSTRUCTIONS: In a continuing effort to make our standardization documents better, the DoD provides this form for use in submitting comments and suggestions for improvements. All users of military standardization documents are invited to provide suggestions. This form may be detached, folded along the lines indicated, taped along the loose edge *(DO NOT STAPLE)*, and mailed. In block 5, be as specific as possible about particular problem areas such as wording which required interpretation, was too rigid, restrictive, loose, ambiguous, or was incompatible, and give proposed wording changes which would alleviate the problems. Enter in block 6 any remarks not related to a specific paragraph of the document. If block 7 is filled out, an acknowledgement will be mailed to you within 30 days to let you know that your comments were received and are being considered.

NOTE: This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, deviations, or clarification of specification requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document*(s)* or to amend contractual requirements.

(Fold along this line)

(Fold along this line)

DEPARTMENT OF THE ARMY
US Army Natick Research and Development Laboratories
Natick, Massachusetts 01760

NO POSTAGE NECESSARY IF MAILED IN THE UNITED STATES

OFFICIAL BUSINESS
PENALTY FOR PRIVATE USE $300
DRDNA-ES

BUSINESS REPLY MAIL
FIRST CLASS PERMIT NO. 12062 WASHINGTON D. C.
POSTAGE WILL BE PAID BY THE DEPARTMENT OF THE ARMY

Commander
US Army Natick Research and Development Laboratories
ATTN: DRDNA-ES
Natick, MA 01760

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-18T00:03Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
MIL-H-13102D	Holder, Cartridge, Belt, Cal. .38, Leather, Black, 6-Round

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	☐ USER
	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER *(Specify)*: _____

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

DD FORM 82 MAR 1426 PREVIOUS EDITION IS OBSOLETE.

NATICK OP, 1 APR 83

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-18T00:03Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.